

GHANA COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY UNIVERSITY



FACULTY OF ENGINEERING
DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER ENGINEERING

DEVELOPMENT AND IMPLEMENTATION OF A ROBOTIC APPLICATION FOR HUMAN INTENTION RECOGNITION USING MOTION AND HAND GESTURE

*A Final Project Report Submitted in Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the
Degree of Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering*

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PRESENTATION OUTLINE

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- 03. System Architecture & 6-Phase Methodology**
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- 05. Experimental Results & ISO Safety Compliance**
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01. INTRODUCTION & RESEARCH BACKGROUND

Robots Working Directly with Humans

Robots are leaving safety cages to work alongside people in hospitals, warehouses, and homes. For humans and robots to coexist safely, the robot must understand where people are and respect their personal space.

Natural, Hands-Free Interaction

Instead of requiring handheld controllers, touchscreens, or keyboards, humans can guide the robot using natural hand gestures and body movement—just like signaling to a human coworker.

Fast Onboard Intelligence (No Cloud Lag)

Sending live video over the internet causes dangerous delays (>200 ms) and fails when Wi-Fi drops. In this project, all AI recognition and navigation decisions happen entirely inside the robot in real time.



Figure 1.1: Collaborative Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) in an industrial shared workspace, illustrating contactless gesture coordination.

02. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Current mobile robots separate vision recognition from active navigation, relying on remote cloud servers that suffer from high network lag (>200 ms) and connection dropouts.

In shared human-robot workspaces, this delay prevents robots from reacting in real time to human gestures, creating severe collision hazards under ISO 15066 safety standards.

PERCEPTION-ACTION GAP

Vision AI isolated from wheel motors & obstacle avoidance
(Tsitos et al., 2022)

CLOUD LATENCY HAZARD

Network lag > 200 ms & Wi-Fi drops
violate ISO 15066 safe stopping
margins

EDGE COMPUTING LIMIT

Heavy vision AI overheats mobile chips; demands a sub-135 ms
onboard pipeline



03. PROJECT OBJECTIVES

GENERAL OBJECTIVE

To design, implement, and evaluate an edge-deployed, real-time human intention recognition and autonomous navigation system powered by ROS 2 on an embedded mobile robot.

01. Invariant Vision Pipeline

Compute 19 scale-invariant geometric features from 21 hand landmarks for real-time onboard MLP classification.

02. Balanced 6,000-Sample Dataset

Capture and balance a custom 6-class dataset directly through the onboard camera to eliminate perspective domain shift.

03. LSTM Trajectory Prediction

Forecast short-horizon operator motion trajectories from continuous body pose landmarks using recurrent neural networks.

04. Supervisory Brain Node

Execute a deterministic finite state machine with 5-frame rolling consensus, active operator lock, and visual servoing.

05. 2D LiDAR SLAM & Nav2

Deploy real-time Cartographer mapping and the Nav2 navigation stack for socially aware, collision-free path execution.

06. Empirical Safety Benchmarking

Quantify end-to-end latency (132 ms), physical classification accuracy (96.7%), and compliance with ISO 15066 safety margins.



04. LITERATURE REVIEW & RESEARCH GAPS

BENCHMARK LITERATURE EVALUATION

Tsitos et al. (2022)

Fast Reaching Intention (Robotic Arm)

- **Strength:** Fast reaction time under 150 ms threshold.
- **Limitation:** Fixed on a desk — cannot drive on wheels or accept hand gestures.

Mahmud et al. (2022)

3D Deep Gesture Tracking

- **Strength:** High accuracy across multi-class hand gestures.
- **Limitation:** Relies on cloud servers — suffers from network lag and Wi-Fi dropouts.

Li et al. (2023)

Intention-Aware Navigation

- **Strength:** Smart path planning around moving humans.
- **Limitation:** Computer simulation only — never tested on a real physical robot.

CRITICAL RESEARCH GAPS RESOLVED IN THIS WORK

01. All-Onboard Edge AI

All computer vision runs directly on the robot (Raspberry Pi 5) without cloud lag, internet dependency, or Wi-Fi dropouts.

02. Direct Vision-to-Wheels

Hand gestures directly guide the robot's physical wheel motors in real time through an active visual-tracking camera gimbal.

03. Dual-Modality & Safety

Unifies 6 deliberate hand gestures with continuous human tracking and automatic 360° LiDAR collision safety stops.

